

AEC 6623: Global Marketing of Agricultural Products

Syllabus: Spring 2025

Course info:

3 Credits, Distance Lecture, Team-teaching

Website: canvas.msstate.edu

Faculty:

Troy Thompson

Lecturer

Agricultural Economics

Email: tnt279@msstate.edu

Virtual Meeting Room in Webex:

<https://msstate.webex.com/meet/tnt279>

Office Hours

5 pm – 6 pm, CST, Thursday
or by appointment

Ayoung Kim, Ph.D.

Assistant Professor

Agricultural Economics

Email: a.kim@msstate.edu

Phone: 662-325-7986

Virtual Meeting Room in Webex:

<https://msstate.webex.com/meet/ak1896>

Office Hours

9 am – 10 am CST, Wednesday
or by appointment

* Disclaimer: This syllabus is subject to change. Any minor revisions to this document will be posted on Canvas, and students will be notified accordingly. (Last updated on 1/10/2025)

Course Description

AEC 6623 introduces students to the economic concept of international trade theory and international marketing strategies and tools. This course will focus on 1) a brief overview of the microeconomic theory of international trade; 2) the effects of government intervention in global agricultural markets; 3) global market planning tools and their applications, and 4) international marketing plans and strategies. This course is team-taught by two faculty members who are knowledgeable in international trade and specialized in the industry (Troy Thompson) and academia (Ayoung Kim). Course contents are delivered completely online using Canvas, canvas.msstate.edu.

Prerequisites

Students are not required to have previous knowledge or training in the theory or applications of international trade. However, you should be familiar with the introductory level of

microeconomics and macroeconomics. It would also help if you were comfortable using simple math (no calculus needed, just algebra), equations, and graphs.

Course Website

All course materials, including lecture notes, readings, assignments, exams, answer keys, etc., will be available through Canvas. Students can access the new weekly set of content starting at **8 am CST every Monday**. Announcements will be notified on the class board. You are responsible for ensuring that 1) you can access Canvas and 2) there is no technical issue with receiving an email. We also suggest you check the announcements and updates regularly. If you cannot access Canvas, contact instructors as soon as possible for assistance.

Technology Requirements

You will need a computer with access to high-speed Internet. Additionally, you will need the following:

- Chrome, Firefox, or an equivalent browser
- Adobe Acrobat Reader ([download here](#))
- (not required but useful) CamScanner (free phone scanner app to create PDF) or any apps that you found

Office Hours

Each instructor has office hours for students. Thompson will have office hours in his Webex meeting room (<https://msstate.webex.com/meet/tnt279>) from 5 pm to 6 pm CST each Thursday. Kim will open her Webex meeting room (<https://msstate.webex.com/meet/ak1896>) from 9 am to 10 am CST each Wednesday. If an additional meeting time is needed, please contact the instructors to make arrangements.

Communication

Instructors will try to answer your questions promptly during business hours, from 9 am–5 pm CST, Monday–Friday. Please note that any questions posted after these times will experience a longer response time. Instructors will have limited availability during night and weekend hours. However, all inquiries should receive a response within 24 hours, except on weekends when the response could take longer. The preferred communication method is email (please include **AEC 6623** in the subject line), but you are welcome to talk on the phone or in the Webex meeting room. Announcements will be used inside Canvas, but you will get an email notification through the university email system. We do encourage you to use the **FAQ Board** if your question will also benefit other participants and is not personal in nature.

Course Rules

Please remember this as you interact with your instructors and fellow participants.

- Follow the rules of netiquette.
- All written communication will be done via Canvas and university email with [@msstate.edu](mailto:msstate.edu)
- **Deadlines (by 11:59 pm CST, Sunday) for any assignments are firm. Late submissions will be reduced by 20% of the total score. Assignments submitted more than one week late will not be accepted.**

Course Materials and Resources

- Steven S. Suranovic, International Trade: Theory and Policy (Open-license textbook, 2010 version)
<https://open.umn.edu/opentextbooks/textbooks/international-trade-theory-and-policy> Or you can purchase the 2015 version of the textbook.
The reading list of each version of the textbook is included in the tentative course outline on page 6.
- Other readings will be assigned from various news articles, journals, books, and research bulletins through Canvas.
- not required, but for students who want more readings
 - James P. Houck, Elements of Agricultural Trade Policies, Waveland Press, Inc 1992
 - Michael R. Reed, International Trade in Agricultural Products, Prentice Hall, 2001

Learning Goals & Objectives

The general purpose of this course is to provide a sound understanding of international economics, analysis tools for global markets, and agricultural trade. The learning objectives are to 1) gain proficiency in theories of international trade, 2) understand trade policy, 3) obtain practical skills for market assessment and analysis, and 4) apply our training to analyze global markets and build marketing planning. By the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. apply basic economic principles and practical tools to the marketing of agricultural products and be able to describe, discuss, and analyze their impact on agribusiness firms
2. identify key issues in international trade and use economic tools to analyze them, for example,
 - develop an understanding of and analyze the economic consequences of trade policies, such as tariffs and subsidies on domestic and foreign markets

- evaluate the impact of exchange rates on agricultural trade
- 3. analyze and solve problems using concepts such as
 - Comparative advantage
 - Partial equilibrium models
 - Producer and consumer surplus in welfare analysis
- 4. analyze international opportunities using basic global market planning tools (SWOT and PESTEL) and develop a global marketing plan
- 5. integrate and effectively communicate the concepts and skills learned in the course

Assessment of Goals

Goals 1-3 will be assessed via quizzes and an exam. Students will also be given graphical models and other exercises that require mathematical calculations to evaluate their understanding of the various theoretical concepts taught in this course.

Goals 1, 4, and 5 will be assessed via topic discussions and the development of a final report. Students will be evaluated based on the degree to which they:

- understand and apply appropriate concepts
- identify the problem and posit a rationale for its successful resolution
- cite and utilize tools that are appropriate for the issue being investigated
- cite appropriate data sources, present and engage the information
- communicate the findings clearly in writing

Course Requirements and Grading

Evaluation of Performance: Students can earn a total of 500 possible points in this course. Your final course grade will have the following benchmarks out of the 500 possible grade points.

First Week Introduction	15 points
Discussion (11 at 15 points each)	165 points
Quizzes (7 at 10 points each)	70 points
Midterm Exam	100 points
Final Project Report	150 points
Total	500 points

Grading scale: A = 90-100%; B = 80-89%; C = 70-79%; D = 60-69%; F = 59% and below

Exams: The take-home midterm exam will be given in the **week of March 3**. The exam will include problems and short essay questions based on materials covered in the course.

The due for the midterm exam is 11:59 pm CST, Sunday, March 9, 2025.

An extension to submit the midterm exam will not be given except in the case of **prior approval from the instructor. You must contact instructors before March 5.** The request for an extension will be considered and may be permitted at the instructor's sole discretion.

Quizzes and Discussion: There are seven short quizzes. Each quiz is worth 10 points. Almost every week, the topics for discussion will be assigned. Students will discuss weekly issues in the **Discussion Board** and must post **at least one opinion AND one feedback**. In order to enrich the discussion, students are encouraged to post discussions during the week and not wait until the final day. Each discussion activity is worth 15 points. Discussions will be assessed based on a rubric provided at the end of the syllabus.

Final Report: The final project report will be assigned as individual work. Detailed guidelines will be provided after reviewing fundamental micro and macroeconomics. This project includes a written project report. The due date is **11:59 pm CST, Sunday, May 4, 2025.**

Grades & Review: All graded work will be returned within one week of the assignment date, and scores will be posted on Canvas. If mistakes are made in grading, or if you have questions about the evaluation, please bring them to our attention as soon as possible.

Academic Misconduct: Academic honesty is expected. All students are expected to be familiar with the Student Honor Code (see Policies on page 7).

Strategies for Success in the Course

We have designed this course so that you can complete the learning modules on a schedule that is comfortable for you. However, we do ask that you submit the products associated with each module by the assigned deadlines at the latest. You should plan time each week to investigate these topics. Also, you may find that you want to explore them in greater detail as your experience, background, and interest may lead you. The key is that you plan and schedule time to work through the course and complete the activities rather than attempt to do it all at once.

Brief Topical Outline

Subject		Approx. # wks
I	Introduction and Scope	2
II	The Analytical Setting of International Trade Policies	5
III	Global Market Analysis and Planning	3
IV	Current Issues/Special Topics	2
V	Exam & Final project	2
Total		14

Tentative Course Outline

Week of	Topic	Notes
Jan 13 – Feb 24 (Weeks 1 – 7)	- Course overview - Introduction of International trade and agricultural products - Review of fundamentals of economics for international trade	Suranovic Ch. 1 (online; 2015)
	- Comparative Advantage and Specialization - Trade and Welfare - Demand, Supply, and Equilibrium - Consumer Surplus/Producer Surplus - Market Planning Tools and Case Study	Suranovic Ch. 2 (2010, online) or Ch. 4 and 5 (2015 version)
	- Trade policy (Tariff) and exchange rate effect (Tariff) - prep midterm exam	Suranovic Ch. 7 (2010, online) or Ch. 10 (2015 version)
Mar 3 (Week 8)	Midterm	
Mar 10 (Week 9)	Spring Break	
	- Pure Exchange Model	Suranovic Ch. 3 (2010, online) or Ch. 2, 6 (2015 version)
Mar 17 - Apr 28 (Weeks 10 – 15)	- Basics global market planning tools (e.g., SWOT and PESTEL) and their application - Entering international markets - Developing the international marketing plan - Special Topic 1-3 (guest lecture) - Topics selected based on students' requests (Supply Chain)	Suranovic Ch. 3 (2010, online) or Ch. 2, 6 (2015 version)
May 4	Class end (Final report due: May 4)	

University Policies

Student Honor Code

Mississippi State has an approved Honor Code that applies to all students. The code is as follows: “As a Mississippi State University student, I will conduct myself with honor and integrity at all times. I will not lie, cheat, or steal, nor will I accept the actions of those who do.” Upon accepting admission to Mississippi State University, a student immediately assumes a commitment to uphold the Honor Code, to accept responsibility for learning, and to follow the philosophy and rules of the Honor Code. Student will be required to state their commitment on examinations, research papers, and other academic work. Ignorance of the rules does not exclude any member of the MSU community from the requirements or the processes of the Honor Code. For additional information, please visit:

<http://honorcode.msstate.edu/policy>

Generative AI

Mississippi State University recognizes the introduction of generative artificial intelligence (generative AI) provides opportunities for scholarly rigor, intellectual integrity, and educational excellence. Nevertheless, the use of generative AI also poses issues related to academic integrity. Currently, individual instructors are encouraged to establish class-specific guidelines concerning the use of generative AI within their courses. The student must consult the syllabus for each class they are taking to determine if and to what degree generative AI is allowed.

Title IX

MSU is committed to complying with Title IX, a federal law that prohibits discrimination, including violence and harassment, based on sex. This means that MSU’s educational programs and activities must be free from sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and other forms of sexual misconduct. If you or someone you know has experienced sex discrimination, sexual violence and/or harassment by any member of the University community, you are encouraged to report the conduct to MSU’s Direction of Title IX/EEO Programs at 325-8124 or by email to titleix@msstate.edu. Additional resources are available at Dean of Students Sexual Misconduct and Sexual Assault (<https://www.students.msstate.edu/sexual-misconduct-sexual-assault/>).

Mandatory Reporting

Faculty members at Mississippi State University are required to report any information received about possible sexual misconduct. This includes information shared in class discussions or assignments, as well as information shared in conversations outside class. The purpose of reporting is to allow MSU to take steps to ensure a safe learning environment for all. The university also has confidential resources available, who can provide assistance to those who have experienced sexual misconduct without requiring a mandatory reporting duty. Students may access confidential campus resources here: Office of Civil Rights Compliance - Title IX and Sexual Misconduct (<https://www.civilrights.msstate.edu/title-ix-sexual-misconduct/resources>).

Disability Resource Center

Mississippi State University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. The Disability Resource Center (01 Montgomery Hall) collaborates with students who have disabilities to arrange reasonable accommodations. If you have, or think you may have, a disability, please contact drc@saffairs.msstate.edu or 662-325-3335 to arrange a confidential discussion regarding equitable access and reasonable accommodations. Disabilities may include, but are not limited to, conditions related to mental health, chronic health, attention, learning, autism, brain injury, vision, hearing, mobility, speech, or intellectual disabilities. In the case of short-term disabilities (e.g., broken arm), students and instructors can often work to minimize barriers. If additional assistance is needed, please contact the Disability Resource Center. For more information, visit <https://www.drc.msstate.edu/>.

University Safety Statement

Mississippi State University values the safety of all campus community members. Students are encouraged to register for Maroon Alert texts and to download the Everbridge App. Visit the Personal Information section in Banner on your [MyState portal](#) to register. To report suspicious activity or to request a courtesy escort via Safe Walk, call University Police at [662-325-2121](tel:662-325-2121), or in case of emergency, call [911](tel:911). For more information regarding safety and to view available training, including helpful videos, visit ready.msstate.edu.

Discussion Rubric

	Excellent (4)	Good (3-2)	Poor (1)	Poor (0)	
Relevance of Post	Posting thoroughly answers the discussion topic and demonstrates understanding. Post makes a strong connection to practice.	Posting addresses most of the subject and demonstrates an understanding and appreciation of the topic. Includes references but may not make full connections to the discussion topic.	Posting fails to address the discussion. Makes short, irrelevant remarks, lacks connection to the discussion topic.	No posting.	___/4
	Excellent (4)	Good (3-2)	Poor (1)	Poor (0)	
Quality of Post	Appropriate comments: thoughtful, reflective, and respectful of other's postings.	Appropriate comments and responds respectfully to other's postings.	Responds, but with minimum effort (e.g., "I agree with Mary").	No posting.	___/4
Contributions to the Class Discussion	Post more than one meaningful content; Attempt to motivate the class discussion; Present creative approaches to the topic.	Attempts to direct the discussion and to present relevant viewpoints for consideration by the group. Interacts freely with the entire group.	Minimum effort is made to participate in the class discussion, including participation near the deadline.	No feedback provided.	___/4
	Excellent (3)	Good (2)	Poor (1)	Poor (0)	
Writing	Writing is free of grammatical, spelling, or punctuation errors	Writing includes less than 5 grammatical, spelling, or punctuation errors.	Writing includes 4-5 grammatical, spelling or punctuation errors.	Writing contains more than 5 grammatical, spelling or punctuation errors.	___/3
				Total	___/15